

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 93-033

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
GERBER-LAS FLORES COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
GERBER WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TEHAMA COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. The Gerber-Las Flores Community Services District (hereafter Discharger) submitted a report, dated 26 October 1992, requesting revision of waste discharge requirements for the expansion of the Gerber Wastewater Treatment Facility for additional flow from sewerage 35 acres of the Las Flores area. The property (Assessor's Parcel No. 64-030-19) is currently owned by the Discharger.
2. The Discharger treats an average dry weather flow of 0.111 mgd of domestic wastewater using aerated lagoon/storage ponds. The Discharger proposes to expand to an average dry weather flow of 0.132 mgd by decreasing detention time and adding 9.5 acres of irrigated pastureland for disposal. Effluent disposal is by irrigation between 15 April and 15 October. The 74.5-acre treatment and disposal site is in the Las Flores Soucos Rancho, projected Section 36, T26N, R3W, MDB&M, as shown on Attachment "A" which is incorporated herein and made part of this Order.
3. The discharge is presently governed by Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 89-196, adopted by the Board on 27 October 1989.
4. The facility was constructed in April 1991 using federal Clean Water Grant funds (Clean Water Grant No. C-06-1881-110) and state supplemental funds. The Discharger plans to expand the facility and sewer the Las Flores area using a state Small Community Grant.
5. Surface soils in the area consist of Maywood silty loam, are well sorted, and have slow permeabilities with slow surface runoff. The area has been flooded for short periods of time, and the ground water is very shallow. The proposed treatment facility is adjacent to a marsh.
6. The average annual pan evaporation in this area is in excess of 60 inches, while the average precipitation is 20 inches.
7. Surface water drainage is to Jackson Creek, a tributary of the Sacramento River.

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8. The beneficial uses of the Sacramento River are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply; recreation; esthetic enjoyment; navigation; ground water recharge; freshwater replenishment; hydroelectric power generation; and preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife, and other aquatic resources.
9. The beneficial uses of the ground water are municipal, industrial, and domestic supply.
10. The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Second Edition, for the Sacramento River Basin (5A), hereafter Basin Plan, which contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
11. The action to adopt revised waste discharge requirements for the existing facility is exempt from provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), Public Resources Code Section 21000, et seq., in accordance with Section 15301 of the California Code of Regulations (CCR).
12. The Discharger has adopted a final EIR in accordance with CEQA, Public Resources Code Section 21000, et seq., and the state guidelines for the expansion of the existing facility and sewerage the Las Flores area.
13. The Board has reviewed the EIR and concurs there are no significant impacts on water quality from expansion of this facility.
14. This discharge is exempt from the requirements of Title 23, CCR, Section 2510, et seq. (hereafter Chapter 15). The exemption, pursuant to Section 2511(b), is based on the following:
 - a. The Board is issuing waste discharge requirements,
 - b. The discharge complies with the Basin Plan, and
 - c. The wastewater does not need to be managed according to 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 30, as a hazardous waste.
15. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge, and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
16. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

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IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 89-196 is rescinded and the Gerber-Las Flores Community Services District, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions

1. The direct discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. The by-pass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.
3. Discharge to unlined evaporation ponds or lined evaporation ponds where the clay liner does not meet the following criteria is prohibited:
 - a. Permeability at any point which is greater than 10^{-6} cm/sec.
 - b. Minimum thickness of two feet of material.
4. The discharge of treated waste to irrigation fields from 15 October through 15 April, except as provided in Discharge Specification B.9., is prohibited.
5. The discharge of waste containing any carcinogen or reproductive toxin listed by the Governor pursuant to Health and Safety Code Sections 25249.5 through 25249.13, the Safe Drinking Water and Toxic Enforcement Act of 1986 (Proposition 65), where such chemical passes or probably will pass into any source of drinking water, is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications

1. The discharge to irrigation shall not contain constituents in excess of the following limits:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Monthly Mean</u>	<u>Maximum</u>
BOD ⁽¹⁾	mg/l	60	120
Settleable Matter	ml/l	0.1	0.2

⁽¹⁾Five-day, 20°C biochemical oxygen demand.

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2. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance or condition of pollution as defined by the California Water Code, Section 13050.
3. The discharge shall not cause degradation of any water supply.
4. The discharge shall remain within the designated disposal area at all times.
5. The 30-day average daily dry weather discharge flow shall not exceed 0.132 million gallons.
6. The storage ponds shall be designed, constructed, operated, and maintained to prevent inundation or washout due to floods with a 100-year return frequency.
7. The storage ponds shall be operated to maintain two feet of freeboard (measured vertically) at all times.
8. Stormwater runoff from the irrigation field shall not be discharged to any surface water drainage course within **30 days** of the last wastewater application.
9. Stormwater runoff from the irrigation field due to excessive rainfall may be reapplied from 15 October to 15 November.
10. Reclaimed wastewater satisfying Discharge Specification B.1. may be used for irrigation of pasture, fodder, fiber, or seed crops.
11. Reclaimed wastewater shall meet the criteria contained in the CCR, Title 22, Division 4 (Section 60301, et seq.).
12. The dissolved oxygen content in any treatment or holding pond shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l for 16 hours in any 24-hour period.
13. Public access shall be precluded from the treatment and disposal area by a satisfactory combination of fencing, signing, and irrigation management practices or some other acceptable methods.
14. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer.

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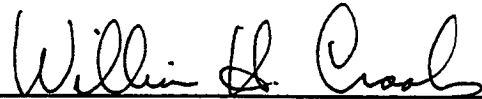
C. Provisions

1. The storage ponds shall be designed to accommodate the 100-year return frequency annual precipitation with a minimum of two feet of freeboard.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 93-033.
3. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements", dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)".
4. The Discharger shall provide certified wastewater treatment plant operators in accordance with regulations adopted by the State Water Resources Control Board.
5. The Discharger shall report promptly to the Board any material change or proposed change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge.
6. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities presently owned or controlled by the Discharger, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be forwarded to this office.
7. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
8. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the discharge facility for reference by operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
9. The Board will review this Order periodically and may revise requirements when necessary.

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I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 26 February 1993.

A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read "William H. Crooks", is written over a horizontal line.

WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

GDD:gln

Amended 2/26/93

Attachments

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 93-033
FOR
GERBER-LAS FLORES COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
GERBER WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
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INFLUENT MONITORING

The Discharger shall implement the influent monitoring program:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Flow	gpd	Cumulative	Daily

STORAGE POND MONITORING

The Discharger shall implement the following monitoring program for the storage ponds:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Freeboard	Feet	--	Weekly
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l	Grab	Weekly

DISPOSAL AREA MONITORING

The Discharger shall keep a log of disposal field observations and include said log in the monthly monitoring report. The log should include the dates of wastewater application and the quantity of wastewater applied. The log should also include the type of crop being irrigated.

RECLAIMED WATER MONITORING

During periods of reclamation, the following constituents shall be monitored:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Reclaimed Water Flow	gpd	--	Daily
20°C, BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Weekly
Settleable Solids	mg/l	Grab	Weekly

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM
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REPORTING

In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner to illustrate clearly the compliance with waste discharge requirements.

Monthly monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the **15th day of the following month.**

If the Discharger monitors any pollutant at the locations designated herein more frequently than is required by this Order, he shall include the results of such monitoring in the calculation and reporting of the values required in the Discharge Monitoring Report Form. Such increased frequency shall be indicated on the Discharge Monitoring Report Form.

Ordered by William H. Crooks
WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

26 February 1993

(Date)

GDD:gl n 1/20/93

INFORMATION SHEET

GERBER-LAS FLORES COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT GERBER WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY TEHAMA COUNTY

The Gerber-Las Flores Community Services District treats 0.111 mgd of domestic waste from the community of Gerber. The treatment system consists of an aeration lagoon, storage ponds, and final disposal by irrigation. Irrigation will occur from 15 April through 15 October. All rainwater which falls in the irrigated lands from 15 October through 15 November will be collected and routed back to the storage ponds.

The facility was constructed in April 1991 using federal Clean Water Grant funds (Clean Water Grant No. C-06-1881-110) and state supplemental funds. The Discharger plans to expand the facility and sewer the Las Flores area using a state Small Community Grant. The Discharger requested revision of waste discharge requirements for the expansion of the Gerber Wastewater Treatment Facility for additional flow from sewerage 35 acres of the Las Flores area. The Discharger proposes to expand to an average dry weather flow of 0.132 mgd by decreasing detention time and adding 9.5 acres of irrigated pastureland for disposal. It has been determined the additional flow will not have a significant impact on the existing facility.

Gerber is a small community ten miles southeast of Red Bluff in Tehama County. It is situated in a low-lying area surrounded by levees on three sides and an elevated railroad track, thus forming a swampy basin area at the north end of Gerber during the wet winter months. There are approximately 375 households and a small commercial center in Gerber. The Las Flores area will add approximately 50 households to the existing facility. The population is generally senior citizens and migrant workers with incomes ranging from low to middle.

The site is in the Las Flores Soucos Rancho (projected Section 36, T26N, R3W, MDB&M). It is between two levees which protect the area from flooding by Elder Creek and Jackson Creek. However, backwashing from the Sacramento River (which is two miles away) has flooded the area. The treatment system was constructed to prevent flooding or washout from a 100-year return frequency flood and to provide storage capacity for a 100-year, 24-hour rain event. To protect local ground water, the storage ponds are clay lined with a permeability of 10^{-6} cm/sec and a minimum depth of two feet of material.

The annual precipitation in the area is 20 inches, while evaporation exceeds 60 inches per year.

